

DELHI

Notes On A Scandal

The Central Bureau of Investigation recently arrested Sudipta Ghosh, former managing director of the Kolkata-based Ordnance Factory Board (OFB), on graft charges. The MD who retired



on April 30 had allegedly received kickbacks from suppliers through a network of Delhi-based agents. Unaccounted cash of Rs 3 crore was also recovered from him. The OFB—a conglomerate of 40 factories with a turnover of around Rs 10,000 crore—has been headless since Ghosh's retirement. Two contenders are battling it out for the top post and the secretary (defence production) is yet to intervene. A.K.

Antony, who took over as defence minister this week has plenty of spring cleaning to do. *by Sandeep Unnithan*

PATNA | Back to Basics

With his lantern flickering in Bihar, RJD chief Lalu Prasad has promised to do what every politician does when pushed against the wall—return to the masses that once sent him to the political centrestage before dethroning him. The former railways minister, who is now in Bihar campaigning for Ram Vilas Paswan's candidate from Fathua for an assembly by-election, said he was in no hurry for Delhi. "I will spend time in Bihar's villages and devote all my time to revive the party," he said. After all, with just four MPs, Delhi no longer holds any hope for the beleaguered Lalu, who seems to have little hopes of getting into the coveted Union Cabinet. Worse still, after his historic drubbing in the Lok Sabha polls, Lalu now fears losing grassroots workers in Bihar. Incidentally, Bihar is set to witness assembly polls in 2010. Bete noire Nitish Kumar, who successfully showcased a better gover-



LALU ADDRESSES A RALLY

nance model and blended it with social engineering to rout Lalu in Bihar, is a bigger challenge. No wonder both Lalu and Paswan are on their toes.

by Amitabh Srivastava

Saffron Sniping

The inner party feuds which contributed in large measure to the BJP's downfall in the elections continue unabated. Some party leaders are now busy pulling each other down with an eye on the Lok Sabha deputy speaker's post.

AHMEDABAD | Far From Over



HK RAJASHEKAR

The ordeal called the Lok Sabha elections may have been over for Narendra Modi, but the Gujarat chief minister is yet to breathe a sigh of relief. The Special Investigation Team (SIT) will now probe the role of Modi and 62 other government personnel and ministers in the 2002 Gujarat riots. Zakia Jaffri, the widow of Congress leader Ahsan Jaffri, who was killed by a Hindu mob in the riots, sought the probe against 62 persons. Last week, the SIT met in Ahmedabad and drew guidelines on how the high-profile investigation should be conducted. It also discussed the measures to protect the witnesses in the cases it is probing in keeping with the Supreme Court directive. On the flip side, almost a dozen witnesses have turned out to be false, and this only adds to the SIT's woes. Clearly, Modi has bigger battles to fight.

by Uday Mahurkar